



ASK YOURSELF... HOW GOOD ARE WE AT INNOVATION?

- Do we have a clear process for making innovation happen, and effective enabling mechanisms to support it as it progresses?
- Do we have a clear sense of shared strategic purpose, and do we use this to guide our innovative activities across the organization?
- Do we have a supportive organization whose structures and systems enable people to be creative and share and build on each other's ideas?
- Do we build and extend our networks for innovation into a rich and open innovation system?
- Do we actively try and learn to develop our capabilities for all of the above?

Measuring your own performance

In addition to organizational targets, it can be useful to monitor your own performance as a manager over the course of an innovation project. Make sure that you take time to review your projects so that you can improve your performance the next time. Learn from your mistakes, and capture what you have learned in a briefing document so that others in your organization can make use of it. Systematically compare your products and processes with those of other firms, and meet and share experiences with people in similar roles to yours. Look beyond your immediate organizational and geographical environment to ensure that you have the widest possible basis for new ideas, and encourage experimentation among your staff. Establish sets of measurable criteria for success to identify how and where you can improve your innovation management.